walked first, carrying his household items, such as food, pots and pans, clothing, and bedsheets. The parade also included important government members and religious leaders. Everyone wore colorful clothing, and everything was decorated in bright colors, even the horses. Thousands of Tibetans lined the route between the palaces dressed in their finest clothes, too. Songs and incense filled the air.





The next day, February 22, 1940, was enthronement day—the day the new Dalai Lama would sit on the throne of Tibet for the first time. The main assembly hall at the Potala Palace was packed with people. The crowd watched the four-year-old boy climb onto the Lion Throne. He sat still all